

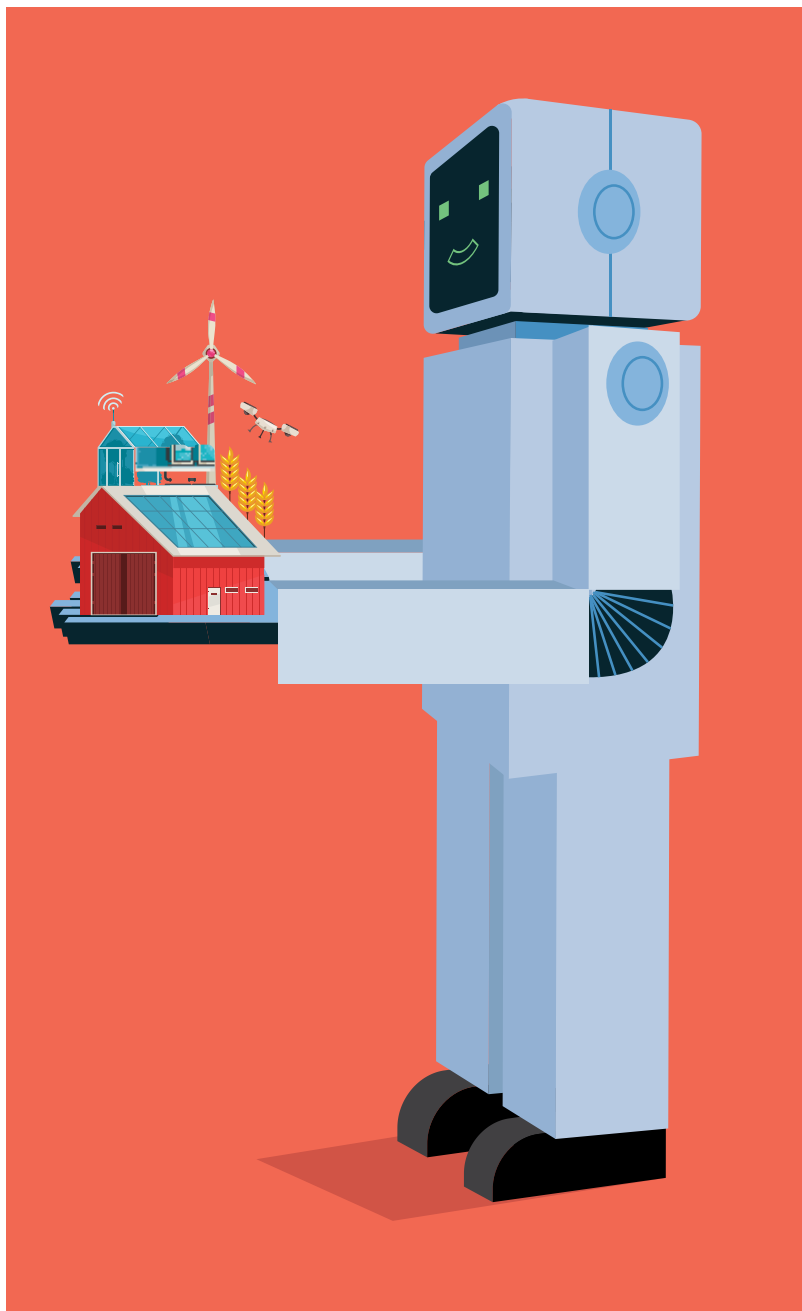


ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

We will need to build our own LLM, and the economics and possibilities of doing this have opened up greatly in the last two years

Technology) has created a national mission around this. True value will be generated and delivered through AI apps built on top of them, and it is here that the animal spirits of our start-ups and IT companies need to be released to unleash a blizzard of AI apps.

What India should also focus on is to fund deep research in AI, where we are severely behind, since the bedrock of AI innovation is research. I do hope that fundamental research also becomes part of a National Mission with our universities and tech companies leading the charge.

However, even as we build the basics, the differentiator would be how we deliver AI to 1.4 billion Indians, and then the world, the same way we delivered digital like UPI and Aadhaar to everyone: by creating DPI and treating it as a free and widely accessible Digital Public Good. This is the 'third path' that India has walked before and where we can innovate once again. If we can build our LLMs and applications as part of the fabled 'India Stack' and deliver the amazing tools and apps that AI enables, we can create a hundred million creators, deliver information and services to the masses, and empower every device and citizen with AI.

I call this audacious initiative 'Jan AI', a play on GenAI, but for the 'Janata', and I do hope that this becomes the core of the National AI Mission, much like DPI was that years ago. This is the 'AI for All' road, less travelled by other countries, which will make every Indian citizen 'AI Literate' and catapult the country to AI glory and leadership and make it a world AI power sitting alongside, and perhaps ahead of, the existing superpowers. **BT**

Views are personal